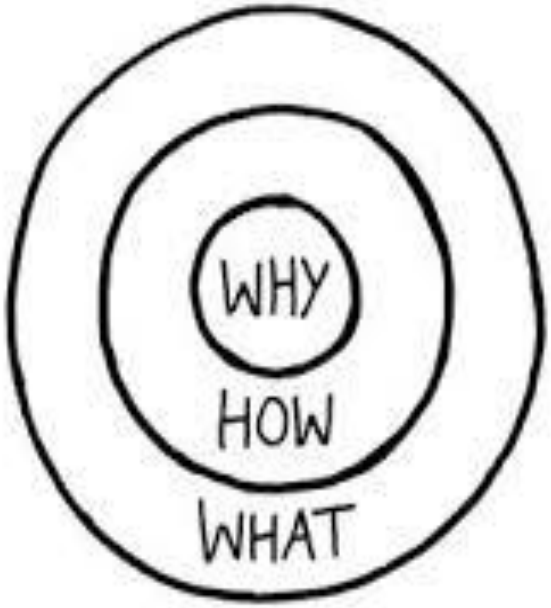
Company Building Framework

The SWG company building blueprint

Where do we start?



- **What** company building trainings and strategies should we be training the teams on and in what order?
- **How** do we help the teams as part of:

  -> The accelerator

  -> 6 months after the program

  -> Post accelerator (long term)
- **Why** will the SWG framework lead to highly successful startups?

Pressure is a privilege – it only comes to those who earn it.
Billie Jean King
quotefancy

WE NEED TO ALIGN ICONS WITH MARKETING WHEN POSSIBLE

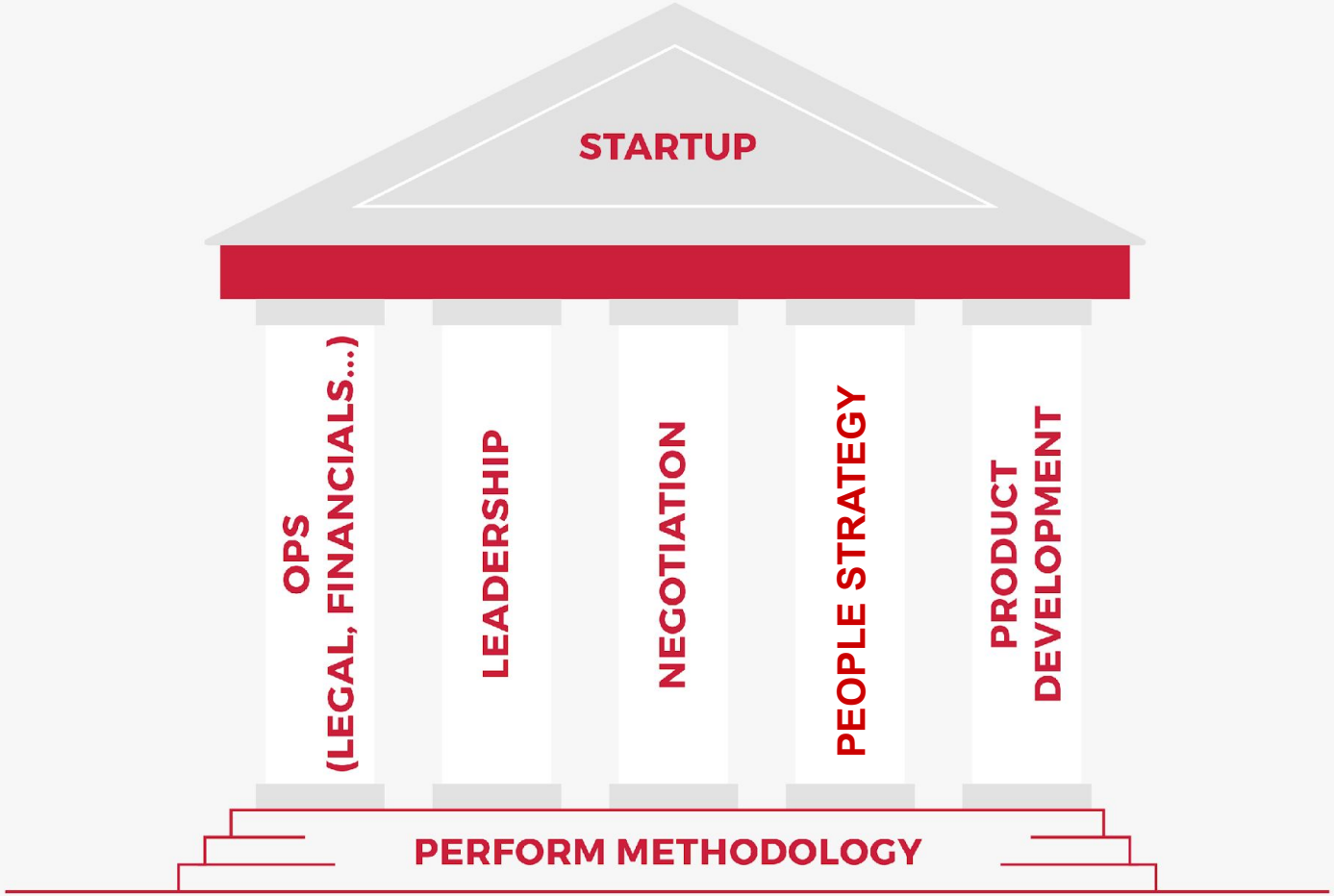
What is the Company Building Chocolate formula?

5 Pillars

1 Methodology

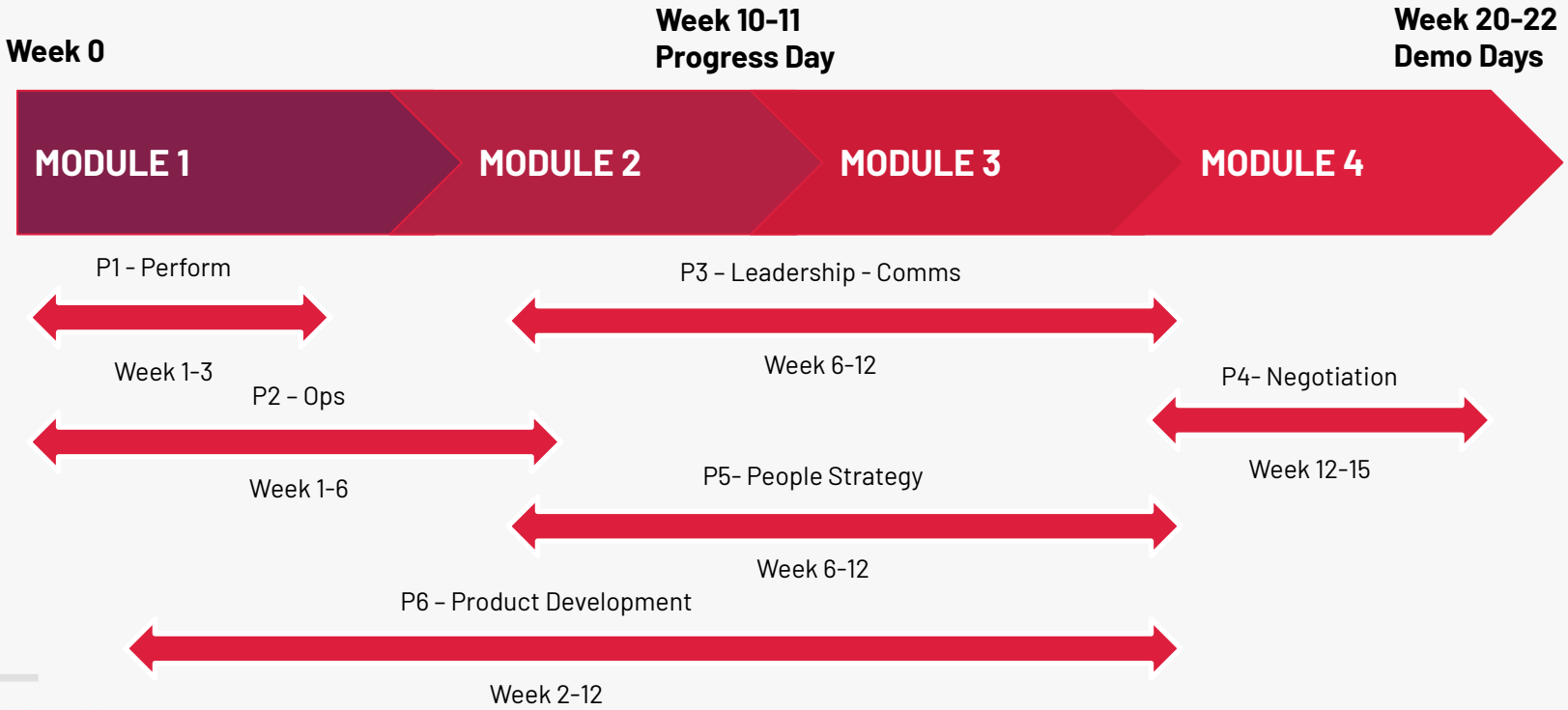
📈 = {🤔 + 🕵️ + 🎯 + 🚀 + 💻 + 📊 + ❤️ + 🔁}

The pillars together support the building of the startup as a company



SWG 📈 Pillar Overview

TO FINALIZE



SWG 📈 Content Overview

Week 0

Progress Day
Program Week 10-11
Content Week 6-7

Demo Day
Program Week 20-22
Content Week 13

MODULE 1 *(Weeks 1-4)*

MODULE 2 *(Weeks 5-7)*

MODULE 3 *(Weeks 8-10)*

MODULE 4 *(Weeks 11-13)*

P-VI Setting Tech Expectations
Uldis Zeidurs
Week 0-2

P-VI Product Sprint
Uldis Zeidurs
Week 3-6

P-VI Blue Ocean Strategy
Farid Singh
Week 8-10

P-IV Negotiations 101
Petra Wolkenstein
Week 11-13

P-I PERFORM workshop
Stoyan Yankov & Cristobal Alonso
Week 1-3

P-III Conversations Worth Having
Miguel Angel Sanz
Week 5-7

P-II Financials & Business Planning
Dag Ainsoo
Week 1-3

P-V People Strategy
Daniela Esposito
Week 5-10

P-VI Experimenting
Farid Singh
Week 2-4

P-II IP & GDPR
Anni Saar
Week 2-4

SWG 📈 Batch Time View

Pillar #	Description	Workshop Topics	Proven Coaches	Other Options	Preferred Weeks
1	**Perform**	Efficient Planning, Focus & Execution, Optimal Energy, Mental Toughness	Stoyan Yankov		Week 1-3 Refresher in weeks 9-11
		Purpose and Values, Roles & Responsibilities, Robust Communication	Cristobal Alonso	Stoyan Yankov	
		People Are Checklists	Uldis Zeidurs		Week 1-4
2	**Operations**	Startup Financials & Business Planning	Dag Ainsoo	MD	Week 1-3
		IP	Anni Saar		Week 2-4
		GDPR	Anni Saar	Risto Hubner	Week 2-4
3	**Leadership - Communication**	Conversations Worth Having	Miguel Angel Sanz		Week 5-7 Follow-on after 4 weeks

SWG 📈 Batch Time View 2

Pillar #	Description	Workshop Topics	Proven Coaches	Other Options	Preferred Weeks
4	**Negotiation**	Negotiations 101 - Use case term sheet	Petra Wolkenstein		Week 11-13
5	**People Strategy**	People Strategy	Daniela Esposito		Week 5-10
		Holistic Hiring	David Bizer		
6	**Product Development**	Product Sprint	Uldis Z., Razvan Suta	Egita Polanska, PM	Week 3-6
		Aligning Product Roadmap with Business Goals	Uldis Zeidurs		Week 1-4
		Experimenting	Farid Singh		Week 1-3
		Blue Ocean Strategy	Farid Singh		Week 8-10

PILLAR #1

PERFORM

Pillar 1 – Perform

What it covers

3-day program

+ 7 Group workshops - one per each topic
+ 5 group exercises- teams work on the initial topic exercises
+ 1-1 with each team to assess more challenging areas
+ 1-1 refresher in the middle of the program

What do teams get

+ How to start defining company values and a methodology to develop this further within team
+ Ability to plan more efficiently on an individual basis
+ Definition of responsibilities within the co founder team
+ Some tools and strategies towards internal communication
+ Reflect on several mental health and energy tools
+ Different tools to help on individual focus

Possible formats and duration

+ 2 days of **6-hour** session in online video-format or live
+ 1:1 with each team **45 min**

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ A methodology to assess 7 key internal company management aspects over time

P URPOSE & VALUES

E FFECTIVE PLANNING

R OLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

F OCUS & EXECUTION

O PTIMAL ENERGY

R OBUST COMMUNICATION

M ENTAL TOUGHNESS

CRISTOBAL ALONSO

El Patron, CEO @SWG

#perform

- **Experience:** 13 years of experience from corporate roles, 12 years in VC backed startups and entrepreneurial. Helped and invested in 200+ startups, grew SWG from a boutique regional accelerator to top 3 in Europe and top 8 worldwide (and it is just the beginning)
- **"Super power":** Execution with a strategic vision and building a powerful culture. "*Pressure is a privilege*"
- **Fun fact:** Played professional basketball and can cook for 50 people anytime

Can help with: living out of the comfort zone, pitching, culture development and PERFORM, 10x strategy, fundraising process and an 8k first degree network

LinkedIn
elpatron@startupwiseguys.com

Stoyan Yankov

Productivity & Performance Coach

#perform

- **Experience:**
  9 years of experience as an entrepreneur with a background in video and movie production, premium event experiences and business networks. Currently a productivity & performance coach, who's helped 150+ entrepreneurial teams in 20+ countries to boost their results through coaching and training, with a focus on culture and performance. Co-creator of the PERFORM Methodology.
- **"Super power":** Building bridges and connecting a-level performers. *"Consistency beats perfection"*
- **Fun fact:** Avid podcast listener and coffee lover

Can help with: Productivity, performance habits, personal growth, founder's psychology & mental state, coaching, storytelling, video production, PERFORM methodology.

LinkedIn
info@stoyanyankov.com

PILLAR #2

Ops

Pillar 2 – Ops
Startup Financials

What it covers

+ How to prepare the financials (Pnl, Cash Flow Plan)
+ Cash Flow, Cash Burn, Runway
+ Basic SaaS metrics
+ Recurring Revenue, Churn, Unit Economics
+ Fundraising

Possible formats and duration

+ 1 hour session in online video-format or live
+ 1:1 with each team (3x45 min)

What do teams get

+ Understanding about basic financial metrics
+ Templates for financial planning
+ Understanding about how to prepare the financials
+ Hands on 1-on-1 advice and guidance on how to move forward

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ They will have up-to-date financials and knowledge about how to do financial planning and manage finances on an ongoing basis.
+ Have clear a understanding of their company cash flow, runway and fundraising options

Dag Ainsoo

Partner, Startup Wise Guys

- **Experience:** Worked in PwC Estonia and Silicon Valley. Founded SmartAD, the largest Internet ad network in the Baltics and sold it successfully to MTG. Helped to build Startup Wise Guys into the leading early-stage accelerator fund in Europe. Investor in over 50 startups.
- **Super power:** Resiliency, enjoying solving hard and long-term problems, staying calm in difficult situations, making friends ☺️
- **Fun fact:** Multiple times Estonian Orienteering sport champion (also won two medals this year in the veteran category)

Can help with: Fundraising, building strategy and financials, making connections

dag@startupwiseguys.com

Pillar 2 – Ops

Data Protection (GDPR)

What it covers

+ Introduction to the topic
+ What do you need in a company to comply with GDPR?
+ Main risks and impact
+ Cases – what to learn from those?

Possible formats and duration

+ 1,5 hour session in video-format or live
+ 1:1 with each team (30 min)

What do teams get

+ Some templates and guidelines to ease their life on meeting GDPR requirements.
+ Understanding their position and their relation to GDPR
+ As a result, they will have better overview of legal requirements, steps to take to comply with GDPR (or at least mitigate the risks as much as possible at the moment) and whether or not to change something within the company

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ They will have documentation and tactics in place (and/or the knowledge) to comply with (or to comply more than earlier with) data protection rules

Pillar 2 - Ops

Intellectual Property (IP)

What it covers

+ Introduction to the topic – what is IP
+ What do you need to look out for?
+ Main risks and impact of having so-so (or no) agreements
+ Cases – what to learn from those?
+ Examples of what to do to protect your company

Possible Formats and duration

+ 1,5 hour session in video-format or live
+ 1:1 with each team (30 min)

What do teams get

+ Understanding of their IP portfolio
+ Some templates to ease their life
+ Understanding what to do to protect the intellectual property of the company
+ Hands on 1-on-1 advice and guidance about how to move forward

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ They will have documentation and tactics in place (and/or the knowledge) to protect (or to protect more than earlier) the company's intellectual property

Anni Saar

CLO, SWG

- **Experience:** I am a visiting lecturer at Tallinn University of Technology, I am a co-author of two academic articles and I graduated my masters (in IT law) cum laude 🎓 Legal Officer with Startup Wise Guys.
- **"Super power":** Legal reasoning, I know a thing or few about IT law, intellectual property, investment agreements and personal data protection and I love negotiations
- **Fun fact:** I speak (Argentian) Spanish

Can help with: Investment agreements, IP and GDPR

LinkedIn
anni@startupwiseguys.com

Risto Hubner

- **Experience:**
- **“Super power”:**
- **Fun fact:**

Can help with:

LinkedIn
email

PILLAR #3

Leadership, Communication

Pillar 3 – Leadership, Communication

Conversations worth having

What it covers

+ Conversations Worth Having: conversations in which we finish with more energy and more ideas for success
+ Learn the skills to turn any conversation into a conversation worth having.
+ We will do this with practical real life examples provided by the participants

What do teams get

+ Teams will realize that a lot of their time is wasted in unproductive conversations.
+ Teams will know how to flip and reframe even the most difficult topics into conversations worth having.
+ As a result, they will be able to have meaningful and productive conversations among themselves, and also with investors, clients, suppliers etc.

Possible Formats and duration

+ 4 hour session in online video-format
+ 2 hour session four weeks later
+ Online support between the sessions (dedicated SLACK channel and 1-1 support)

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ The vast majority of their conversations will be worth having, with lots of ideas for greater results and success

Miguel Angel Sanz

People Accelerator

- **Experience:** 15 years of experience in national and international executive roles, leading sales and engineering teams in 15 countries. 4 years as Investment Director of a European investment fund. 5 years with my own company. Executive Education experience in top business schools.
- **"Super power":** Making online workshops engaging, enjoyable and productive.
- **Fun facts:** Besides a PhD in engineering... I have a Master in Theater and Performing Arts!

Can help with:

Providing purpose and speed to people in businesses.

Sales at C-level and leading sales teams.

LinkedIn
miguelangelsanz@madavi.es

PILLAR #4

Negotiations

Pillar 4 – Negotiations

STARTUP WISE GUYS

What it covers

+ Basics of negotiations with long-term relationship persons (single issue, e.g. sales, multiple-issue, e.g. investor term sheets)
+ Pie mechanics
+ Optimizing preparation and process
+ Option development and closing a deal
+ Difficult people and moments
+ Specifics of negotiations via email

Possible Formats and duration

+ 4-5h workshop online or live
+ Session on the basics + Case preparations and parallel negotiations + joint debrief of tactics, comparing of results
+ 1:1 or small group discussions on their negotiation challenges
+ Negotiation learnings via small negotiation exercises in teams

What do teams get

They will be able to:

+ Analyze negotiation situations and define the critical stuff to do
+ Change processes and pie mechanics

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ Increased comfort in negotiating
+ Improved results on single negotiations

Petra Wolkenstein

M&A and Growth Expert @ Konsultori and driving force of key2investors

- **Experience:** 19 years buying and selling companies (M&A) in the tech field, supported numerous startups in getting investors on board, built key2investors, influenced and still supports the Vienna Startup Package.
- **"Super power":** is a driving force for her customers, i.e. acts as an external reference person to deliver what needs to be done. Has absolute fun training people.
- **Fun fact:** lives in an urban jungle, loves languages and classical music – *the stereotype of a Viennese*

Can help with: funding process, investor profiling, internationalization and negotiations.

LinkedIn
petra.wolkenstein@konsultori.com

PILLAR #5

People Strategy

Pillar 5 – People Strategy

What it covers

1. People workshop:
Hiring - asking the right questions & using the right recruitment channels
Hiring, engaging and retaining - defining & implementing a total rewards strategy

2. Performance and Culture workshop:
Performance - managing & improving performance with OKRs, continuous feedback & recognition
Culture - setting it right from day one and developing it with purpose & values

What do teams get

+ How to find & select your core team in person or over video
+ Setting a total reward strategy to attract & retain talents - monetary & non-monetary
+ Building a purpose & performance driven culture in a physical or virtual team - Engagement, OKRs & continuous feedback
+ Specific feedback on each startup and tips/techniques/KPIs to become more effective on People Strategy

Possible Formats and duration

3 days program

+ Pre-workshop short Survey to fine-tune the content
+ Group workshop A - People, **2 hours**
+ Group workshop B - Performance & Culture, **2 hours**
+ 1-1s with the founders or with the team member in charge of the People strategy - **30min**

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ People Strategy will naturally become a core skill and success factor
+ Entrepreneurs will be able to measure how successful their People Strategy & Tools are, via specific KPIs, and address those as needed

Daniela Esposito

People Rocks

- **Experience:** 12 years of experience in international corporate roles, plus the last 6 years spent with startups. Helped a number of entrepreneurs as Advisor, Investor or Interim Director, contributing to two exits in 2018 (meritocracy & Musement)
- **"Super power":** Acting locally but thinking globally. Connecting the dots.
- **Fun facts:** Used to own a go-kart, and a racing one ... Can also fix everything at home by herself, from painting to changing pipes!

Can help with: building multi-cultural physical or remote teams, effectively aligning the organization to the business, project & change management, handling critical discussions & driving critical business transformation initiatives

LinkedIn

David Bizer

People Rocks

- **Experience:**
- **“Super power”:**
- **Fun facts:**

Can help with:

LinkedIn
bizer@talent.vc

Google Founders Lab - Founders Leadership and Teamwork

What it covers

- How do you create a strong co-founding team that is able to scale well?
- How do you solve for your most difficult people challenges and deal with the pressures of starting a company?

Possible formats and duration

- Full day workshop (on-site)
- 3 hour workshop split into two sessions of 1.5h each (online)

About:

- Target participants: Co-founders, can be alone or with the whole team
- Mentor: Zachary Ross https://www.linkedin.com/in/zacharypross/

Administration:

- Mentor free of charge
- Google covers transportation and accommodation if needed
- SWG covers lunch and minor costs if needed (e.g. coffee, snacks, equipment for the workshop)
- Mentor needs to be confirmed with Google at least 1 month in advance via alona@startupwiseguys.com
- If in person, can be used only for Baltics

Google Founders Lab - Founders Leadership and Teamwork

More info:

Google's Founders Lab was created out of the discovery of a staggering statistic: according to a survey of VCs by Harvard Business School, the biggest reason for startup failure at 65% was people issues. Primarily conflict among co-founders, but also the inability to hire or retain strong talent, or to get people to work with commitment towards to goals. And so Google's team that supports startups realized — we need to help them with their people issues!

At this interactive workshop, we will share practical tools from Google's research that can improve Founder dynamics, enable more effective team culture, and debug challenges with employees.

PILLAR #6

Product Development

Pillar 5 – Product Development

Product Sprint

A Sprint is a unique five day process for validating ideas and solving big challenges through prototyping and testing ideas with customers. Not only do we help our teams find qualified answers to BIG questions, we also teach them the sprint methodology itself

What it covers in 5 full days

+ 2-3 days of intensive workshops, ideation and decision-making
+ 1 day of hard prototyping work, using creative tools
+ 1 day of leading and participating in customer interviews

What do teams get

Clear answers to their BIG unanswered business questions

+ Improved internal alignment of their team, leading towards better teamwork
+ Knowledge about particular sprint exercises, and how to run meetings effectively
+ Understanding of how to run customer interviews, and why they're important
+ Hands-on experience with safely experimenting on a budget

How we prepare

+ 1hr call with the teams to explain what a sprint is and why we run it
+ 2hr call with dedicated teams' facilitators explaining the whole sprint agenda, their responsibilities and exercises in detail
+ PMs to support the teams in selection of the facilitators

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ When they get stuck with a BIG question in the future, they'll be able to run a Sprint on their own to find the answers
+ They will have become more effective and productive in their internal meetings and workshops

Uldis Žeidurs

Geek at heart

- **Experience:** 20+ years in IT, in many different roles; software development focus
- **Super power:** providing simple answers to complicated questions (and vice versa)
- **Fun fact:** once passed an Expert13 level song on ITG2

Can help with - development roadmaps, business goals, business analysis, team management, tech stack decisions and pretty much any other IT-related topics

LinkedIn

uldis@startupwiseguys.com

Geek in Residence

Egita Polanska

All around startupper

- **Experience:** working with startups since 2013, managing accelerator batches, working on scouting, partnerships and operations. Helping to build startup ecosystem in Latvia & beyond.
- **Super power:** problem solving
- **Fun fact:** likes to run around the forest and abandoned building searching for adventure

Can help with: pitch to investors/stage pitch, business development, team management

LinkedIn

egita@startupwiseguys.com

Programs and partnerships in SEE

Venture partner in Italy

Razvan Suta

Born an raised in the land of Dracula
Based, studied, lived and worked in Denmark

- **Experience**: Founder, event manager, moderator, business consultant, tech enthusiast, activating in the startup scene of Denmark and Estonia for the past 5 years.
- **"Super power"**: In my spare time I connect people aka community builder & enabler by nature
- **Fun Fact**: occasionally intervention manager, fashion consultant for my flatmates

Can help with: pitching drills & feedback, pitch deck review, business basics, soft funds applications, startup ecosystem in the Nordics

LinkedIn
razvan@startupwiseguys.com
Business developer & Special events

Pillar 6 – Product Development

Experimentation

A practical look into exploratory and validation experiments, driven from design thinking methods, to gather insights, facts and inferences. Participants learn the basic experiments that help them gather information to make decisions

What it covers

+ The different types of experiments with examples
+ Top risks for your business
+ Clear steps on how to build a experimentation culture

What do teams get

+ Why validation experiments are the wrong place to start
+ Top failures for early stage startups
+ Why surveys are incredibly dangerous
+ Difference between insight, inference and facts
+ The top 4 experiments for startups to execute

Possible Formats and Duration

+ Startups fill up a pre workshop activity sheet that asks uncomfortable questions
+ Dedicated workshop and follow up 1-1s let startups work on specific experiments for their business at their stage of maturity

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ Overtime, the company builds an experimentation culture
+ Every decision has an insight behind it, driven by explicit intent to find out more

Pillar 6 – Product Development

Blue Ocean Strategy

A practical leap into this powerful and now essential strategy on how to make your competition irrelevant. Very useful for startups who are tight on resources, and cannot afford to compete with more cash rich players

What it covers

+ Understanding of competitive and creational strategy
+ Blue Ocean Strategy basics and examples
+ Tools to use to develop strategy
+ 4 most powerful Blue Ocean Strategy methods

What do teams get

Besides the ability to not mistakenly use the term Blue Ocean Strategy interchangeably with Blue sky thinking

+ Awareness and knowledge on customer product levers
+ Product development skills used by industry leaders
+ Blue Ocean strategies specific to startups, making sure they use their time wisely

Possible Formats and Duration

+ Startups fill up a pre workshop activity sheet that asks uncomfortable questions
+ Dedicated workshop and follow up 1-1s let startups work on specific strategies for their business at their stage of maturity

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ Overtime, the company builds a Blue Ocean Goto for every competitive challenge
+ The product development will focus on Value and cost optimisation to focus on very specific market segments

Farid Singh

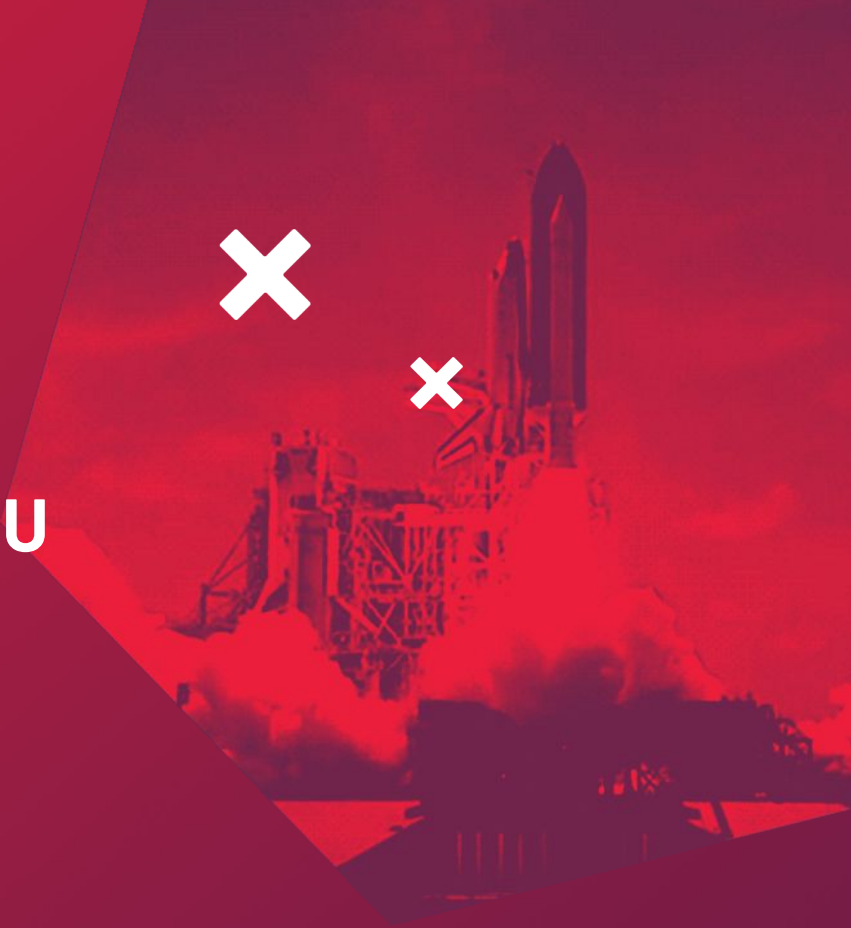
Innovation Guru

- **Experience:** 13+ years in TMT and innovation, in many different roles; work at the intersection on Creative thinking, technology and business
- **Super power:** Helping make competition irrelevant by focusing creational strategy
- **Fun fact:** Survived 5 large earthquakes

Can help with: Building purposeful companies, value proposition, customer discovery, problem solution, product market fit, blue ocean strategy and experimentation

LinkedIn
farid@startupwiseguys.com

THANK YOU



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